

RESONANCE AI4D Lab website

Site reviewed: sites.google.com/aait.edu.et/resonance-lab (all 9 pages), 3–4 October 2026

Method: Chrome at 1440 px and 390 px, Lighthouse 12, manual accessibility review, comparison with four similar sites

The lab's content is strong: a clear mission, four well-defined research themes and a detailed call for applications. **The way the site is built hides most of it.** Every section is a Google Sites *Custom embed*, a separate document inside an iframe. Phones cut these off, search can't read them, and each one loads its own copy of a development-only CSS framework. Outdated dates, placeholder text and an inconsistent visual style then undercut the credibility a university lab needs.

34 / 100

Lighthouse performance score on mobile

27.3 s

until the main content appears on a phone

5.6 MB

downloaded for the homepage, in 65 requests

0

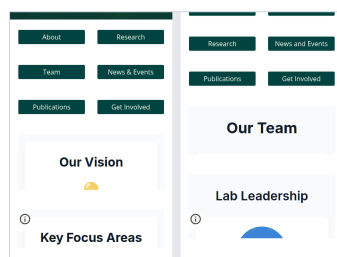
site-search results for "agriculture", a core research theme

ISSUES AND RECOMMENDATIONS, MOST CRITICAL FIRST

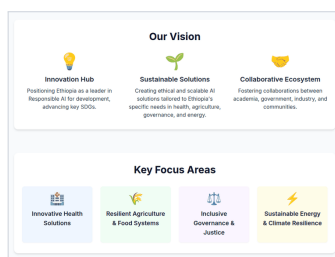
#	ISSUE	SEVERITY	RECOMMENDATION
1	Content cut off on phones Each section is an iframe with a fixed height ratio. At 390 px the homepage shows only section headings, and the Team page shows no names.	CRITICAL	Move content out of Custom embeds into real page content (native Google Sites blocks or a small static site).
2	Outdated and placeholder content The homepage says applications "are now open" for a call that closed in August 2025. Publications lists "Title goes here"; the phone number is "+251 XXX XXX XXXX".	CRITICAL	Mark the 2025/26 call as closed, remove placeholders until real entries exist, and give News & Events an owner and a review date.
3	Very slow to load A 1.1 MB seal is shown at 56 px, a 1.7 MB PNG draws a simple gradient, and each embed loads Tailwind's development CDN.	CRITICAL	Draw the hero background in CSS, resize the seal to about 10 KB, and drop the per-embed CDN and fonts.
4	Homepage doesn't say who the lab is RESONANCE is never spelled out; Addis Ababa University appears only as a seal. The first screen holds only the name, with no mission or contact details.	HIGH	Open with the full name, a one-line mission and the AAU / CTBE affiliation.
5	Navigation hidden and inconsistent All pages are nested under a "Home" dropdown. Boxy button rows change on every page, labels vary, and Contact is missing from all of them.	HIGH	One flat text menu with consistent labels, the current page marked, and a proper menu on phones.
6	Invisible to search Site search finds nothing, because the text lives inside embeds. Page descriptions read "Our Partners:", "About", "Team".	HIGH	Real page content, with a descriptive title and description for every page.
7	Accessibility barriers Logos have no alt text, and the white-on-lime banner has 2.05 : 1 contrast. Emoji are read aloud, and every iframe is announced as "Custom embed".	HIGH	Add alt text, meet WCAG AA contrast, use one heading outline, and add visible focus states and a skip link.
8	Emoji used as icons They look different on every device and read as informal next to a university seal.	MEDIUM	Simple SVG line icons in the brand colour.
9	Inconsistent typography Five font families on one page: Roboto, Google Sans, Playfair Display, Open Sans and Inter.	MEDIUM	Two typefaces at most: one for headings, one for text.

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10	Off-brand colours, boxy layout Tailwind blue, purple and orange next to the lab green, a lime gradient, and cards nested inside grey panels.	MEDIUM	A brand-green palette (#005747) and one card style.
11	Header title too long “RESONANCE AI4D Lab @CTBE” in a display serif reads like a social-media handle, and the emblem is the AAU seal, not a lab mark.	MEDIUM	A short wordmark, with “AI4D Lab · Addis Ababa University” set small beneath it.
12	Oversized, unbalanced footer Partner logos run full width at uneven sizes (about 600 px tall on phones), with no alt text and no address, email or links.	MEDIUM	A compact footer: contact details, page links, and partner logos at equal height.
13	Placeholder team avatars Coloured circles with first names written inside (“Dr. Elefelious” shrunk to fit), plus six “To be recruited” cards.	MEDIUM	Real photos (with consent) or two-letter initials in one colour, and open roles listed in one line.
14	Inconsistent naming and copy “Resonance Lab”, “RESONANCE AI4D Lab” and “Resonance AI4D Lab” all appear. There are small errors (“an Masters position”), and the Masters entry requirement differs between pages.	LOW	One copy-editing pass and one official name.

EVIDENCE FROM THE LIVE SITE



Issue 1: Home and Team at phone width



Issue 8: emoji used as icons



Issue 13: placeholder avatars with names inside



Issues 5 and 11: long title, empty hero, boxy button row



Issue 12: oversized partner logos; no contact details

PATTERNS FROM COMPARABLE SITES

Makerere AI Lab, Stanford HAI, Masakhane and AI4D Africa

- One line on the first screen saying who they are and where
- A single row of text links for navigation
- SVG icons, and one or two typefaces
- A compact footer with contact details and logos at equal height
- Masakhane also runs on Google Sites but keeps text in the page, so it reads fine on phones

WHAT THE HOMEPAGE PROTOTYPE COVERS

Issues 1 and 3–12 on the homepage, plus its parts of 2 (call status shown from its dates, no placeholders), 13 (initials) and 14 (one name). All content comes from the live site; nothing is invented.

NEEDS THE LAB

A real publications list, the phone number, team photos, keeping News & Events up to date, and a lab logo.

Full assessment with screenshots, measurements and benchmark comparison: [ASSESSMENT.md](#) in the project repository.